Choosing my goal this week

A stand-alone 60-minute group session for adult alcohol and other drug (AOD) day programs and rehabs. Works for a first-day member and a returning member in the same room.

> **The one idea: your goal is yours, and it can change.**

1. Bridge — 3 min

"Today's one idea: your goal is yours, and it can change. If you're new, you don't need to know anything from before today. If you've been here a while, think about how your goal has moved since you started. What's said here stays here."

2. Check-in — 10 min

One line each: *"This week my goal is to stop, cut down, or not decide yet."* Members may pass. Write the three options on the board with no names next to them, so no goal is ranked above another.

3. Activity: the goal card — 20 min

Hand out the goal card (page 2). Each member fills in four lines: my goal this week; one reason it matters to me; one thing that could get in the way; one person or place that helps. Respond to every card the same way: *"What made you write that?"*

Fictional example: Dev, on his first day, writes "not decide yet" and "my sleep" as his reason. Lou, in her sixth week, crosses out "stop" and writes "cut down on weekdays". Both cards get the same question and the same respect.

4. Two levels of question — 15 min

First-time members: *"What's one thing you noticed about your use this week, without changing it?"*

Returning members: *"How is the goal on your card different from the one you came in with, and what changed it?"*

5. Close — 12 min

Each member names one small step for the coming week that fits their own goal. Then read the safety line below, every time.

Safety line (read aloud): *"If your goal involves cutting down or stopping alcohol or tablets like benzodiazepines, talk to the team about a medical check first. That's a safety step, not a judgement."*

Why: Healthdirect Australia warns that withdrawal from alcohol or benzodiazepines can be life-threatening and advises talking to a doctor or AOD service before stopping. Follow your service's withdrawal, overdose and emergency policies. Facilitators do not give dosing advice.

Educational resource. Not medical advice; it does not replace clinical training, supervision, medical assessment or your service's policies. Fictional examples. © 2026 Thoughtkind Press · Heba El Garhy · More sessions and sources: thoughtkindpress.com/guides/harm-reduction-group-activities/

My goal this week

☐ Stop ☐ Cut down ☐ Not decide yet

One reason it matters to me

One thing that could get in the way

One person or place that helps

One small step before next group

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☐ Stop ☐ Cut down ☐ Not decide yet

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Planning to cut down or stop alcohol or benzodiazepines? Talk to the team about a medical check first. © 2026 Thoughtkind Press · thoughtkindpress.com · For the moments a group stalls: When Group Gets Stuck (thoughtkindpress.com/books/when-group-gets-stuck/)